

PulseCare: Strategic Business Case & Architecture Alignment

February Jiang, yj2918

1. The Core Problem: The Visibility Gap

The eldercare market is trapped between invasive surveillance (cameras, location trackers) and reactive panic buttons (Life Alert). There are 72 million independent seniors in the US, and they systematically under-report health issues to avoid burdening their adult children.

Currently, families rely on weekly phone calls where vital, slow-moving health signals—like accumulating sleep debt or transient dizziness—vanish in casual conversation. By the time the caregiver realizes there is a problem, the leading indicators have already culminated in a crisis, such as a fall. PulseCare captures these invisible leading indicators, transforming qualitative daily interactions into quantitative, predictive medical alerts.

2. The Users: A Dual-Sided Model

PulseCare serves two distinct users with opposing psychological profiles. The product fails if it doesn't satisfy both.

- **The Buyer (The Caregiver):** Adult children (typically 40–60) managing their own households. They are time-poor and anxiety-rich. They don't want raw data; they want **synthesis, clinical translation, and predictive certainty**.
- **The End-User (The Senior):** Adults over 65 living independently. They fiercely protect their autonomy and resist anything that feels like medical monitoring. They want **companionship, low-friction interactions, and dignity**.

3. The Retention Engine: The Zen Garden

A predictive health model is only as good as its daily data ingestion. If the senior doesn't log in, the product dies.

To solve the cold-start problem of daily health tracking, PulseCare utilizes the **Zen Garden**—a behavioral retention engine disguised as a UI feature. It reframes a clinical health log into a shared family ritual.

- **For the Senior:** Every conversational check-in grows a virtual plant. It offers a low-pressure, visual progression (Seed to Paradise) that provides a dopamine hit and a reason to open the app even on "good" days.
- **For the Caregiver:** The dashboard features "Water" and "Fertilize" buttons.

This creates a loop of **gamified reciprocity**. The senior inputs critical health data to grow the

garden; the caregiver engages with the garden to show presence. It shifts the paradigm from "my daughter is monitoring my health" to "my daughter and I are tending to this together."

4. Competitor Landscape & Market Positioning

The current market relies heavily on hardware or single-modality solutions. PulseCare operates as a zero-friction software layer.

Competitor Category	Key Players	The Flaw	PulseCare's Advantage
Reactive Hardware	Life Alert, Medical Guardian	100% reactive. Highly stigmatized. Users frequently refuse to wear them.	Predictive & Dignified: Catches the 14-day decline <i>before</i> the fall occurs. Zero hardware stigma.
Raw Wearables	Apple Watch, Fitbit, Oura	High noise, high false positives. Fails the "stoic senior" test (biometrics without context).	Cross-Modal Synthesis: Combines raw watch data with conversational NLP context to eliminate false positives.
Dedicated AI Companions	ElliQ	Expensive proprietary hardware (\$250+ setup, \$40/mo). Lacks deep caregiver dashboard integration.	Zero-Hardware SaaS: Runs entirely in the browser using the Web Speech API. Instantly deployable.

5. The Economics: High-Margin SaaS

PulseCare is designed for near-zero marginal cost, protecting a massive gross margin while remaining highly affordable for the consumer.

- **Pricing:** \$29.00 / month per caregiver.

- **Unit Economics (Per User / Month):**
 - **Daily Base Check-ins:** ~30 runs of Companion Agent (low token count).
 - **Analyst Runs:** ~9 runs (only triggers ~30% of the time on significant signals).
 - **Total LLM Cost:** ~\$0.06 (Gemini 2.0 Flash).
 - **Total COGS (Infrastructure + Compute):** ~\$0.36.
 - **Gross Margin:** ~98.8%.
- **The Moat:** The switching cost is the senior's longitudinal health history. After 60 days, the highly calibrated personal baseline *is* the product. Caregivers will not churn if it means losing that predictive safety net.

6. Technical Architecture as Business Leverage

Every engineering choice in PulseCare is a direct answer to a business requirement or cost constraint.

- **Conditional Multi-Agent Routing (Cost Control):** A single LLM cannot be both empathetic (for the senior) and strictly clinical (for the caregiver) without hallucinating or bloating prompt costs. PulseCare uses LangGraph to route intelligently. The cheap, empathetic **Companion Agent** handles daily intake. The expensive, clinical **Analyst Agent** *only* fires when a threshold signal (e.g., severity > 5) is detected. This preserves the 98% margin.
- **Hybrid RAG (Trust & Safety):** Caregivers are paying for medical reliability. By grounding the Analyst Agent in a geriatric knowledge base via FAISS + BM25, PulseCare eliminates LLM medical hallucinations, validating the \$29/mo price tag.
- **Tool Calling (Data Structuring):** Unstructured chat is useless for long-term health monitoring. By enforcing a log_health_entry tool call on the first conversational turn, PulseCare guarantees that qualitative conversation is immediately converted into the structured database rows needed to power the predictive alerts.